In reply to Abdulla Husain Salem Hadna Almessabi
Peer Response
by Abdulrahman Alhashmi - Sunday, 2 November 2025, 2:25 PM

Your analysis highlights the key conflict: large-scale self-rule without clear human oversight can cause damage. Building on that, the ACM Code demands that computing experts prevent harm, work for the public good, and take blame for results. Deadly self-rule tests these rules since prediction, checking, and blame are still debated. Law backs this worry. Nations need to run Article 36 checks on weapons to ensure they meet rules on targeting differences, balanced force, and care in fights; full or half self-targeting makes these checks hard and muddies blame among makers, users, and leaders (Schmitt and Thurnher, 2013; Crootof, 2015).

The BCS Code matches ACM in four areas: help the public, stay skilled, act honestly, and face up to duties. Here, being professional means three clear steps: build with human oversight and check records; note and raise likely bad uses; reject rollout if dangers can't be limited. These steps fit global rules that push for reliable actions, real human input, and clear choice paths (UN GGE, 2019; ICRC, 2021). They match tech advice on openness, challenge options, and duty to share issues (IEEE, 2019).

Harms to society go past war zones. Tools for watch and track that serve two ends, quieted protests, and uneven mistakes hitting overlooked groups break down trust. To guard people, experts must: demand human checks for deadly tasks; require test teams to probe weak spots; share reports on problems after use; and back safe ways to report wrongs under both codes. Plan with care. Record with truth. Share soon. This forms the right road when tech speeds past rules.

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In reply to Abdulla Husain Salem Hadna Almessabi
Re: Peer Response
by Aneta Worku - Sunday, 2 November 2025, 6:12 PM

This is a very good explanation of the ethical and legal issues around autonomous weapon systems. I agree that Q Industries went against the main rules in both the ACM (2018) and BCS (2019) Codes of Conduct. Allowing weapons to act on their own breaks Principle 1.2 of the ACM which focuses on avoiding harm, and ignores the moral duty that computing professionals have to protect people and society (Bowyer, 2000).

I also agree with your point about the social impact as using this kind of technology could create fear, misuse, and a loss of public trust. As Cath (2018) explains, technologies that risk people's rights can also weaken democracy which is worrying.

You are right that the law including the Geneva Convention says humans must take responsibility in war (Docherty, 2020). Machines can't do this, so using them in this way is both unethical and legally wrong. This case highlights how important it is to think about ethics at every step of system design.

Both ACM and BCS stress honesty, responsibility, and the public good values that Q Industries failed to follow. Ethical computing should always put people's safety and wellbeing before profit or technology (Malikovich et al., 2023).

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In reply to Abdulla Husain Salem Hadna Almessabi
Peer Response
by Rayyan Mohamed Abdalla Alshambeeli Alnaqbi - Monday, 3 November 2025, 7:10 PM

Hey Abdulla,

You have done a good job of describing the big moral, legal, and social problems that come up with autonomous weapon systems. Q Industries' choice to create deadly autonomous technologies goes against a number of important parts of the ACM Code of Ethics, especially the duty to "avoid harm" (1.2) and to "contribute to human welfare" (1.1). Giving these kinds of systems the power to make life-or-death decisions takes away human responsibility, which makes it much more likely that they will be misused, biased, or wrongly targeted, especially when they are used with surveillance tools like facial recognition.

The BCS Code of Conduct (2019) says the same things, telling professionals to act in the public's best interest, respect human rights, and be honest. Moreover, international humanitarian law, including the Geneva Conventions, mandates the presence of a responsible human actor in wartime decisions, a condition that autonomous systems cannot assure (Docherty, 2020).

In terms of ethics, employees who spoke out about these practices did the right thing by putting public safety ahead of company loyalty. In general, this case shows that technological ability should never be more important than moral duty or responsibility.

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In reply to Abdulla Husain Salem Hadna Almessabi
Peer Response
by Saleh Almarzooqi - Monday, 10 November 2025, 5:18 AM

Hi Abdulla

The moral and juridical issues of autonomous lethal systems that you addressed in your interpretation of the Automated Active Response Weaponry case are quite able to be discovered. I do think that the actions of Q Industries are a direct infringement of the principles of ACM Code of Ethics that state 1.1 (Contribute to society and human well-being) and 1.2 (Avoid harm) (Association for Computing Machinery (ACM), 2018). Introduction of autonomous weapons with a lack of effective accountability measures reflects the disregard for Principle 2.5 that mandates professionals to make systems safe and reliable.

In addition, your mention of the international humanitarian law is also very pertinent. According to Docherty (2015) and Cath (2018), the fact that autonomous systems have no human supervision is a cause of concern regarding the issue of incorrect deaths and adherence to the Geneva Convention. The moral conflict between the research and humanitarian responsibility can be seen here.

Comparing the British Computer Society (BCS) Code of Conduct (2019) with the two frameworks, the key similarity lies in the fact that they all lead to the importance of the public interest and professional integrity. The BCS also highlights the responsibility of respecting and valuing alternative opinions, and this was not the case in Q Industries, as it sacked employee whistleblowers.

In general, the case highlights that the development and promotion of technology should continue to be morally responsible and based on the humanistic rule.

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